

is also JSON support to let multiple channels communicate with servers.

Apart from exchanging messages, the new Vim is capable of starting a job, communicating with the same job and then stopping it. All this can be done



through channels, and jobs can also read from or write to a buffer or file.

The new version also has timers to fire a function once, repeatedly, or invoke right within the code. Also, Vim has got partials to bind arguments or a dictionary and package support to manage the collection of plugins.

For an easy way to create functions, Vim 8.0 includes the 'lambda' and 'closure' arguments. There are also some

new style tests to let developers quickly write tests and keep them updated. Assert functions and a framework to run tests are available to further ease developments.

In addition to the major changes, the updated version of Vim has some minor tweaks like windows IDs and timestamps. The text editor includes DirectX support and a GTK3 GUI toolkit.

Besides, Vim 8.0 fixes various bugs that were found in its previous versions.

You can install the latest Vim version on any of your Linux, UNIX, Windows or Mac OS systems. It will soon debut on platforms like AmigaOS and several other Linux distributions.

Apache Syncope 2.0 brings identity management to IoT world

The Apache Software Foundation has released Apache Syncope 2.0 as the new version of its digital identity and access management system. This new open source offering brings identity management to the IoT world.

Using Java EE technology, Apache Syncope 2.0 provides a powerful and flexible solution to keep enterprise identity data consistent and synchronised across multiple repositories, data formats and models.

"Syncope 2.0.0 is a major milestone for the community," said Francesco Chicchiriccò, vice president of Apache Syncope, in a statement. "The numbers of this release look great — new features, new components and tools, new contributors, more enterprise appeal, and even more extensibility," he added.

The new Syncope is capable of defining and managing object types like workstations, printers, folders, sensors and services, among others. This feature makes it a possible enabler for IoT developments. Also, there is a revamped Web administration console with a fresh look and features, as well as a self-service Web application with an option to let users edit details from their end.

Apache has designed the identity management system to facilitate multi-tenancy and physically separate data of distinct domains into different database instances. This helps in picking up multiple object types and opens up new avenues for IoT devices.

Developers are provided with new 'getting started' and reference guides to help them build their solutions using the Syncope solution.

"Apache Syncope documentation is here to eliminate this Achilles' heel. We're looking forward to welcoming new Syncope users," Chicchiriccò added.

The Apache Foundation mentioned that its Syncope is already used by various organisations, including ARAG, Azienda Ospedaliera di Padova, PTC Vufornia, University of Helsinki and UShareSoft.

Originally created at Italian software company Tirasa, Syncope entered the Apache incubator in February 2012. The open source project has had 30 releases since becoming a top-level project (TLP) in November 2012.

Mirai Trojan aims to hit Linux-based IoT devices

While a lot of ransomware and malware were targeting desktops in the past, a new Trojan has emerged to hit Linux-based IoT devices in an uncomplicated way. Codenamed Mirai, the Trojan performs DDoS attacks to silently infect connected devices.

MalwareMustDie researchers spotted the Mirai Trojan. It previously entered the malware domain under names such as Gafgyt, Lizkebab, BASHLITE and Torlus.

"Some cases of the Linux/Mirai infection are showing traces that the malware was executed without parameter, and there are cases where the downloaded malware file(s) is deleted after execution. In this case, mostly, you won't get the samples unless you dump the malware process to the ELF binary," one of the researchers wrote in a blog post.

The DDoS Trojan aims to hit IoT devices with platforms like ARM, MIPS, PPC, SH4, SPARC and x86. It also targets hardware with the Busybox GNU library.

MalwareMustDie first researchers spotted the 'dvrHelper' string in the Mirai code. This suggests that the malware is targeting DVRs and IP cameras. But the Trojan could also let attackers access unattended Linux servers using the same structure. Additionally, it is considered that Linux devices based on x86-32 architecture are not on the priority of the DDoS Trojan, as most of the samples are powered by ARM chips.

Users are recommended to apply some securing methods on their devices to protect themselves from Mirai. Moreover, server administrators and sysadmins can deploy some mitigations at their end to filter brute-force traffic from the newest malware.